25900585 MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCPSY201 – CHILD DEVELOPMENT

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes (2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS) Maximum Marks: 50

Part A Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. According to stage theorists, which statement best describes children's development?

c) All children follow the same orderly sequence of developmental childhood stages

2. Classical conditioning was brought by

a) Pavlov

3. If poor nutrition delays walking, this shows the effect of

a) Environment on motor skills

4. A pre-schooler calls a camel a "lumpy horse". According to Piaget this is an example of?

b) Assimilation

5. Which of the following is one of the first areas to become sensitive to touch during the prenatal period?

b) Mouth

6. . An Apgar score of 7–10 is considered:

a) Normal and reassuring

7. Whose theory was the first to stress the influence of early parent–child relationship on development?

b) Erikson

8. Why do avoidant children avoid their caregiver?

d) Learned caregiver is unresponsive

9. Ethology contributes to human psychology mainly by:

b) Highlighting adaptive significance of attachment and bonding

10. Which of the following is not part of grammar?

c) Pragmatics

11. Intermodal sensitivity is crucial for _____

b.Intermodal perception

12. What is the type of processing that allows us to handle more than one stimulus at a time?

b) Parallel

13. Which hemisphere is more involved in spatial abilities like judging distances and reading maps?

b) Right hemisphere

14. **What is the name of the second stage of the psychosocial theory?**

c) Autonomy versus shame and doubt

15. **Which sounds do babies begin producing around 2 months?**

c) Cooing

16. **What is the function of Moro reflex?**

b) May help the infant cling to mother

17. Self-efficacy refers to:

b) Belief in one's ability to succeed in a task

18. **Play that mainly involves interaction with peers, such as turn-taking and conversations is called:**

c) Social play

19. **Which type of child may have irregular routines and be resistant to change?**

b) Difficult

20. **A child grows normally again after illness. This is called:**

b) Catch-up growth

[1x20 = 10]

Part B

Short Essay Questions. Answer any 10 question out of 13. Each question carries 3 marks

21. Explain any three maternal factors that affect the prenatal development. [K] / [CO2]

Maternal exercise, nutrition, Emotional well-being, mother's age is major maternal factors that affect prenatal development.

Exercise: Moderate exercise (walking, swimming, biking, and aerobics) is **beneficial** — it increases **birth weight** and **reduces risks** of complications such as: Pregnancy-induced **diabetes**, **High blood pressure. Excessive vigorous exercise** can **lower birth weight**.

Nutrition: Healthy diet with weight gain supports mother and baby's health. **Malnutrition** in **First trimester** leads to miscarriages, physical defects. **Later malnutrition** results in low birth weight, small head size. The malnutrition mother can result in brain damage, Organ defects, Low Immunity, Low Intelligence, Behavioural Problem

Maternal Stress: Severe maternal stress especially in 1st–2nd trimester may cause risk of **miscarriage, prematurity, low birth weight**, illness, and sleep and behaviour problems. Stress hormones increase **fetal heart rate, BP, glucose**, long-term risk of **heart disease & diabetes**.

Maternal Age: Delayed childbearing increase the risk **miscarriage, chromosomal defects.** Risks **increase sharply after 40**

22. Explain how the exosystem differs from the macrosystem in the ecological system theory. [An] / [CO3]

The exosystem consists of links between a social setting in which the individual does not have an active role and the individual's immediate context. For example child's experience at home may be influenced by a mother's experiences at work

The macrosystem involves the culture in which individuals live. Culture refers to the behavior patterns, beliefs, and all other products of a group of people that are passed on from generation to generation.

23. What are self-conscious emotions? How do toddlers express them? [U] / [CO3]

Self-conscious emotions (embarrassment, pride, envy, shame, guilt) are **higher-order evaluations of the self** that appear late in the second year (18–24 months), coinciding with the toddler's development of **self-awareness**. Early signs include eye-lowering (shame/embarrassment) and guilt-like reactions, with pride and envy present by age 3. These emotions require **adult instruction** for appropriate expression, which is culturally variable. By age 3, these feelings are linked to self-evaluation; for instance, pre-schoolers show greater pride in difficult successes. Crucially, as children mature, **school-age children** begin to feel pride and guilt **without adult monitoring** and only experience guilt for **intentional wrongdoing**, reflecting a more advanced moral sense.

24. Describe the structure of temperament according to Thomas and Chess. [U] / [CO3]

Thomas and Chess's model of temperament, consisting of nine dimensions ; **9 Dimensions:** Activity Level, Rhythmicity, Distractibility, Approach/Withdrawal, Adaptability, Intensity of Reaction, Threshold of Responsiveness, Quality of Mood, Persistence.

Based on the clustering of these dimensions, Thomas and Chess identified three common temperament types:

> **Easy Children** (40%): Generally cheerful, quickly establish regular routines, and adapt easily to new experiences.
>
> **Difficult Children** (10%): Irregular in daily routines, slows to accept new experiences, and tend to react negatively and intensely.
>
> **Slow-to-Warm-Up Children** (15%): Inactive, show mild, negative reactions to new stimuli, but slowly adjust over time with repeated exposure.
>
> The remaining 35% of children have temperaments that are combinations of these traits.

25. What are the 2 types of morality according to Piaget? [U] / [CO3]

Heteronomous Morality (5–8 years): Children see rules as fixed, unchangeable laws given by authority figures and must be obeyed. Due to cognitive immaturity and adult control, they show **moral realism**—believing rules are absolute and not open to change which reinforced by adult figures.

Autonomous Morality / Moral Relativism (9-10 and older): With **cognitive development**, **peer interaction**, and **less adult control**, children enter the **morality of cooperation** stage, viewing rules as **flexible and socially agreed upon**. They develop a sense of **reciprocity**, showing equal concern for others' welfare as for their own.

26. Explain the structure of fallopian tube. [An] / [CO2]

Fallopian tubes —long, thin structures that lead to the hollow, soft-lined uterus. Fallopian muscular ducts that connect the ovaries to the uterus. They serve as the pathway for the ovum (egg) to travel from the ovary to the uterus and are typically the site of fertilization.

27. How does culture influence cognitive development according to Vygotsky? [An] / [CO3]

Lev Vygotsky's sociocultural theory posits that **human cognition is inherently social and language-based**, thereby emphasizing the central **role of culture on development**. Infants are born with **basic perceptual, attention, and memory capacities** (shared with other animals) that develop through direct contact with the environment during the first two years. However, it is the subsequent **rapid growth of language**, acquired through cultural and

social interaction that leads to a profound change in thinking, transforming these basic capacities into higher-order cognitive processes.

28. Explain the role of heredity in determining growth. [K] / [CO2]

Identical twins are much more alike in body size than fraternal twins which indicate the role heredity in growth. When diet and health are adequate, height and rate of physical growth are mostly determined by heredity. If negative environments are not severe children and adolescents typically show catch-up growth —a return to a genetically influenced growth path once conditions improve. Genes regulate growth through body's production of and sensitivity to hormones (Growth Hormone). Genetic mutations can cause size variations

29. Explain Conventional Level in Kohlberg's theory?

At the **conventional level**, moral reasoning is based on **maintaining social rules and order**. People obey rules not for self-interest but to **preserve relationships** and **ensure social harmony**. The sub stage includes

Stage 3 – "Good Boy–Good Girl" Orientation:
Moral behaviour aims to **gain approval** and **maintain social harmony** through being **kind, loyal, respectful, and helpful**. Individuals understand **ideal reciprocity**—the **Golden Rule** —treats others as you wish to be treated.

Stage 4 – Social-Order-Maintaining Orientation:
Morality is based on **obeying laws and fulfilling duties** to maintain **social order and cooperation**. Moral choices no longer depend on close ties to others. Rules are seen as necessary and must apply **equally to everyone**.

30. How does the expression of happiness change from infancy to toddlerhood?

Happiness initially manifests as **blissful smiles** and later as **laughter**, contributing to the infant's **social, cognitive, and motor development**. Newborns smile when full, during REM sleep, or in response to soothing input like gentle touches and the mother's soft voice. The **social smile** develops between 6 and 10 weeks, followed by **laughter** around 3-4 months, which signals faster information processing. By the middle of the first year, infants prefer familiar people, and the combined expressions of smiling and laughter strengthen the **parent-child bond**. By 10-12 months, babies exhibit various types of smiles.

31. What are the stages of child birth?

Child Birth divided into 3 stages

Dilation and Effacement of Cervix: Longest stage — 12–14 hrs (first birth), 4–6 hrs (later births). Uterine contractions widen and thin the cervix, forming the **birth canal**.

Delivery of the Baby: Lasts about **50 mins (first birth)**, **20 mins (later births)**. Strong contractions and mother's pushing expel the **baby**.

Birth of the Placenta: Final stage lasts **5–10 mins**. Contractions detach and expel the **placenta** from the uterus.

32. Explain Sub stages of Sensory motor stage

Piaget divided the **Sensorimotor Stage (birth–2 years)** into **six sub stages** showing how infants move from simple reflexes to mental thinking. In the **reflexive stage (0–1 month)**, behaviour is based on innate reflexes like sucking and grasping. In **primary circular reactions (1–4 months)**, infants repeat actions centered on their own body, such as thumb sucking. During **secondary circular reactions (4–8 months)**, they repeat actions that affect the environment, like shaking a rattle. In the **coordination of secondary schemes (8–12 months)**, behaviour becomes intentional and goal-directed; object permanence begins to develop. The **tertiary circular reactions (12–18 months)** involve active experimentation and curiosity, where infants vary actions to see new results. Finally, in the **mental representation stage (18–24 months)**, children form internal images and symbols, allowing for symbolic play and deferred imitation and immediate problem solving

33 Why authoritative parenting style is considered as the most balanced style?

The **authoritative child-rearing style** is the most successful and balanced approach. It involves **high acceptance, involvement, adaptive control,** and **appropriate autonomy granting**. Authoritative parents are **warm, attentive, and responsive** to their child's needs, creating a close and emotionally fulfilling relationship. They set **firm but reasonable rules**, explain expectations, and use discipline as a way to **teach self-regulation**.

They encourage **open communication** and allow children to make decisions suited to their maturity. This balance of guidance and independence fosters **self-control, confidence, academic success, social responsibility, and moral maturity** in children.